

Allegiant Travel Company

Business Development Dossier

Industry	Airline / Leisure Travel
Revenue	\$2.8B
Employees	7,000
Ideal Customer Profile Score	91

ICP SCORING MODEL



ICP = Signals + Revenue + Employees + Fit (max 100)

Signals (0-35)	Top 4 signals scored; each = base(60%) + recency bonus <30d: 40% <90d: 30% <180d: 20% older: 10%
Revenue (0-25)	\$500M-\$10B sweet spot -> 70-100% of 25 pts Below \$500M -> pro-rata x 0.5 Above \$10B -> 60%
Employees (0-20)	2,000+ preferred (70-100%) 500-2K partial (50-70%) Below 500 -> pro-rata x 0.3
Fit (0-20)	High-fit types: reorg, transformation, M&A, hiring, funding, partnership -> 5 pts ea (max 12) + diversity 2/type (max 8)

Prepared March 19, 2026

McChrystal Group

Leadership Advisory & Organizational Effectiveness

SECTION 1

Organization Snapshot

Legal Name	Allegiant Travel Company
Headquarters	Las Vegas, Nevada
Founded	1997

Ownership

Public (NASDAQ: ALGT); Maury Gallagher serves as Chairman. Post-merger: Gallagher remains Chairman, Sun Country CEO Bricker joins board.

Footprint

Allegiant operates from 24+ U.S. bases; Sun Country from Minneapolis-St. Paul hub plus Cincinnati base (opening early 2026). Combined network: 200+ routes across the U.S. Sun Country's 20 cargo aircraft operate primarily for Amazon out of multiple hubs.

SECTION 1b

Company Overview

Allegiant Travel is a leisure-focused U.S. airline that announced a \$1.5B acquisition of Sun Country Airlines in January 2026, creating the largest leisure-focused carrier in the U.S. The combined entity will operate ~190 aircraft (Airbus + Boeing mixed fleet), serve 200+ routes, manage Sun Country's Amazon cargo operations, and integrate two pilot unions - creating one of the most complex airline integrations in recent years.

SECTION 2

Financial Health & Growth Stage

Understanding Allegiant Travel Company's financial position and trajectory is critical to framing any engagement conversation.

Revenue: Allegiant: ~\$1.95B (9 months ending Sep 2025); Sun Country: ~\$846M (same period). Combined annual revenue ~\$2.8B.

Fleet: Allegiant: 82 A320s, 29 A319s, 10 B737-MAX8s; Sun Country: 50 B737NG passenger + 20 B737NG cargo. Combined: ~190+ aircraft (mixed fleet creates operational complexity).

Merger Economics: Transaction values Sun Country at ~\$1.5B including \$400M net debt. Expected synergies not yet fully disclosed. Integration costs will be significant.

Analyst Sentiment: Mixed. Industry analysts question strategic logic ("Allegiant to Buy Sun Country and I'm Not Sure Why" - Cranky Flier). Integration execution is the key risk. Antitrust clearance de-risks regulatory hurdle.

Key Pressures: Mixed fleet (Airbus + Boeing) creates maintenance and crew training complexity; pilot union integration (ALPA + IBT) historically contentious in airline mergers; cargo operations add business model complexity; integration costs during uncertain economic environment.

Key Tailwinds: Antitrust clearance secured (March 2026); combined network reaches more leisure destinations; Sun Country's cargo revenue stream (Amazon) adds diversification; potential for expanded co-branded credit card revenue.

SECTION 3

Leadership Team Profiles

The following contacts are recommended as primary outreach targets - champion-level leaders who feel the organizational pain daily and can sponsor McChrystal internally.

Robert Neal - President & Chief Financial Officer [PRIORITY TARGET]

Will serve as President and CFO of combined entity; key financial and operational integration leader

Outreach rationale: As President AND CFO, Neal will be the operational execution leader for the integration - managing fleet decisions, route optimization, financial integration, and day-to-day operations. This dual role means he feels every integration challenge. Natural champion for McChrystal's operating model work.

SVP of Operations / Integration - SVP Operations [INFERRED] [PRIORITY TARGET]

Responsible for fleet integration, crew scheduling, route network optimization, and maintenance operations

Outreach rationale: The operational integration leader who must merge two airlines' day-to-day operations - flight operations, crew scheduling, maintenance, and ground operations - while maintaining safety and schedule reliability. Every airline merger succeeds or fails at this level. This is where McChrystal's coordination expertise creates the most value.

Additional leadership team members relevant to the engagement:

Gregory C. Anderson - Chief Executive Officer

Will lead combined entity post-merger

Jude Bricker - Board Advisor (former Sun Country CEO)

Will serve as advisor to CEO Anderson to 'help ensure a smooth and successful integration'

Maury Gallagher - Chairman of the Board

Founding-era chairman; controls significant ownership stake; will chair combined entity board (expanded to 11)

SECTION 4

Organizational Culture & Structure

Culture and structure are often where McChrystal Group finds the deepest leverage. The following signals indicate how Allegiant Travel Company operates today and where friction exists.

Organizational Structure

Post-merger: Combined leadership with Allegiant executives in CEO and President/CFO roles. Sun Country CEO (Bricker) as board advisor provides cultural bridge. Board expanded to 11 (3 from Sun Country). Operational integration will require merging two complete airline operations: flight ops, maintenance, crew scheduling, ground ops, cargo, and commercial.

Culture Signals

Two Distinct Airline Cultures: Allegiant's ultra-low-cost culture (maximize revenue per aircraft, minimal frills) meets Sun Country's hybrid model (scheduled + charter + cargo). These are fundamentally different operating philosophies that must merge.

Pilot Union Friction: ALPA (representing Sun Country pilots) and IBT (representing Allegiant pilots) must negotiate seniority list integration - historically the most contentious issue in airline mergers. Seniority determines pay, schedule, and aircraft type for the rest of a pilot's career.

Cargo Operations Complexity: Sun Country's Amazon cargo operation is a completely different business with different metrics, customers, and operating rhythms. Preserving this revenue stream while integrating the passenger operation adds organizational complexity.

Founder-Led vs. Professional Management: Allegiant has been shaped by Maury Gallagher's entrepreneurial, cost-obsessed culture. Sun Country's more recent professional management (under Jude Bricker) is more structured. Merging these styles requires deliberate cultural design.

Glassdoor: [INFERRED] Allegiant reviews often cite cost-cutting culture and operational demands; Sun Country reviews tend to be more positive on culture but note growth challenges.

SECTION 5

Recent News & Trigger Events

The following developments from the past 18 months create urgency and provide natural conversation entry points for engaging Allegiant Travel Company.

1. 2026-01-11 - Allegiant announced \$1.5B acquisition of Sun Country Airlines

One of the largest U.S. airline mergers in years - creates massive organizational integration challenge across every function

2. 2026-03-16 - Received antitrust clearance (HSR early termination) from DOJ

Regulatory green light means integration planning can accelerate - the window between clearance and closing is prime engagement time

3. 2026-06-01 - Merger expected to close mid-2026 [PROJECTED]

Day 1 integration requires operational readiness - safety-critical airline operations cannot have integration gaps

4. 2026-01-11 - ALPA (Sun Country pilots) issued statement on merger; plans to negotiate seniority list integration with IBT (Allegiant pilots)

Pilot seniority integration is historically the most contentious and time-consuming element of airline mergers - can take years if mishandled

5. 2026-01-01 - Sun Country opened new operational base at Cincinnati/Northern Kentucky International Airport

New base adds to integration complexity - must be incorporated into combined network planning

SECTION 6

McChrystal Fit Assessment

Tier 3 (unconventional) but with extremely strong organizational fit. The Allegiant-Sun Country merger is a high-stakes, multi-dimensional integration challenge where failure has safety and operational consequences. Antitrust clearance creates immediate urgency. The pilot union integration alone could take years without structured coordination. Revenue \$2.8B supports advisory spend. McChrystal's military credibility in high-consequence operational environments is a unique differentiator that aviation-specific consultants lack.

Primary Problem

Integrating two complete airlines - different fleets (Airbus + Boeing), different pilot unions (ALPA + IBT), different business models (ultra-low-cost + hybrid charter/cargo), and different cultures - while maintaining uninterrupted, safety-critical operations that passengers' lives depend on.

Best McChrystal Capability Fit

High-stakes operational integration and cross-functional coordination - airline mergers are among the most complex organizational challenges because they're safety-critical, union-constrained, and operationally interdependent. McChrystal's military background in coordinating complex operations under pressure (where failure has real consequences) is the direct capability fit. No strategy firm replicates the operational coordination credibility.

Likely Objections to Engagement

Airline integration is a specialized domain - does McChrystal understand aviation?

We have aviation consultants and integration specialists already

Union negotiations are a legal/labor relations issue, not an organizational design issue

Budget is being consumed by integration costs

Competitive Advisory Landscape

Oliver Wyman Aviation - specialized airline strategy and integration

Seabury Group - airline restructuring and integration specialists

McKinsey Travel & Transport - airline merger strategy

Internal: Allegiant has some acquisition experience but nothing at this scale

SECTION 7

Conversation Entry Points

These questions are designed for a Senior Partner's first conversation. Each opens a thread that naturally leads to McChrystal Group's capabilities without a direct pitch.

1. With antitrust clearance in hand and closing expected mid-2026, what's the integration planning process looking like - and where do you see the highest risk to Day 1 operational readiness?

Start with their top-of-mind concern (closing/Day 1 readiness) and surface the organizational coordination challenges

that aviation consultants may not address.

2. How are you thinking about the pilot seniority integration between ALPA and IBT - and what's the plan for maintaining operational coordination between the two pilot groups during what could be a multi-year negotiation?

Show awareness of the most contentious element of airline mergers. Position McChrystal as addressing the organizational coordination challenge around the union process, not the labor negotiation itself.

Recommended Meeting Framing

Frame as a conversation about what McChrystal has learned from high-stakes operational integrations where failure has real consequences - not theoretical business risk, but safety and operational risk. The military parallel is genuine: merging two special operations units with different cultures, equipment, and operating procedures is the direct analog to merging two airlines.

SECTION 8

Brand Insights & Market Positioning

Brand strategy reveals organizational priorities and coordination challenges. The following analysis connects Allegiant Travel Company's market positioning to potential McChrystal engagement opportunities.

Brand Position: Allegiant is positioned as the ultra-low-cost leisure carrier - point-to-point service to vacation destinations at rock-bottom fares. Sun Country is positioned as a more balanced hybrid - scheduled service, charter flights, and cargo. Post-merger brand strategy must decide: does Sun Country become Allegiant, maintain its brand, or something new?

Brand Integration Challenge: Customer-facing brand decisions (livery, boarding experience, loyalty programs, route marketing) must align with operational integration. If the brands merge too fast, customer confusion; too slow, missed synergy.

McChrystal Connection: The brand promise of 'reliable, safe, affordable leisure travel' depends entirely on operational coordination. A botched integration that causes delays, cancellations, or safety incidents destroys brand equity overnight. McChrystal's operating model ensures the brand promise is operationally achievable during integration.

SECTION 9

Deep McChrystal Group Fit Analysis

This is the strategic case for pursuing Allegiant Travel Company. It synthesizes findings from all previous sections into a comprehensive engagement thesis with specific fit dimensions, expected outcomes, stakeholder mapping, and a phased pursuit strategy.

9a. Fit Dimensions

Fit Dimension 1: Safety-Critical Operational Integration

Airlines are the most safety-critical commercial operations. Every integration decision - crew scheduling, maintenance procedures, dispatch protocols, emergency procedures - must maintain safety standards while changing underlying systems. McChrystal's military experience in high-consequence operational environments provides unique credibility. Oliver Wyman provides aviation strategy; McChrystal provides the operational coordination discipline that prevents integration gaps from becoming safety gaps.

Fit Dimension 2: Union-Constrained Organizational Change

The ALPA/IBT seniority integration constrains every other integration decision - aircraft assignments, base allocations, schedule construction, and route planning all depend on the seniority outcome. McChrystal's operating model builds coordination mechanisms that function during extended uncertainty - enabling the organization to operate effectively while the seniority negotiation plays out over months or years.

Fit Dimension 3: Multi-Business-Model Integration

Allegiant (ultra-low-cost passenger) + Sun Country (hybrid passenger/charter/cargo) means integrating organizations with fundamentally different success metrics, customer value propositions, and operational rhythms. The Amazon cargo relationship adds a B2B dynamic to what was a B2C airline. McChrystal's cross-functional coordination model ensures these different businesses reinforce rather than conflict with each other.

9b. Cumulative Case

Allegiant-Sun Country is the highest-stakes Tier 3 opportunity in the pipeline. Signal chain: \$1.5B merger -> antitrust clearance (Mar 2026) -> mid-2026 closing -> mixed fleet (Airbus + Boeing) -> dual pilot unions -> cargo operations -> 200+ route network -> combined 7,000 employees. Every airline merger in history has succeeded or failed based on operational integration and cultural alignment, not strategy. Revenue potential: \$400K-\$500K initial (integration coordination design), \$1M-\$1.5M deployment through integration, \$300K-\$500K ongoing. Total: \$1.5M-\$2.5M over 24 months.

9c. Enterprise Issues

1. Mixed Fleet Complexity: Operating both Airbus A320-family and Boeing 737-family aircraft requires dual maintenance infrastructure, training programs, parts inventories, and crew certifications. This creates cost and coordination overhead. 2. Pilot Seniority Integration: The single most contentious element. ALPA and IBT must negotiate a combined seniority list. This process can take years and generate significant labor unrest. 3. Cargo Operations Preservation: Sun Country's Amazon cargo business operates on a different cadence and contract structure than passenger operations. The merger must not disrupt this revenue stream. 4. Cultural Clash: Allegiant's ultra-low-cost DNA (every penny matters) meets Sun Country's more service-oriented culture. Combining these creates friction at every operational touchpoint. 5. System Integration: Reservation systems, crew scheduling software, maintenance tracking, and revenue management must either integrate or run in parallel - both options are expensive and complex. 6. Customer Experience Continuity: Passengers on both airlines must experience seamless service through the integration - cancellations, delays, or service degradation destroys brand equity.

9d. Expected Outcomes

1. Day 1 Operational Readiness: Integration coordination plan ensuring seamless operations from closing day. Measurable: zero integration-caused safety incidents or operational disruptions at closing. 2. Cross-Airline Coordination Cadence: Operating rhythm connecting Allegiant and Sun Country operations during the multi-year integration period. Measurable: integration milestones on-track with <10% variance. 3. Union Integration Support: Organizational coordination framework that enables operations during seniority negotiation. Measurable: operational metrics maintained within 5% of pre-merger baseline during negotiation period. 4. Cargo Continuity: Coordination mechanisms preserving Sun Country's Amazon relationship. Measurable: zero Amazon service level agreement violations during integration. 5. Cultural Integration: Shared identity and operating norms for combined 7,000-person organization. Measurable: employee engagement scores stabilized within 12 months.

9e. Key Stakeholders

CEO

Leader: Gregory Anderson

Role: Combined entity leadership

McChrystal Relevance: Executive sponsor

President/CFO

Leader: Robert Neal

Role: Operational + financial integration

McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Dual-role execution leader

SVP Operations

Leader: [INFERRED]

Role: Flight ops, crew, maintenance integration

McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Safety-critical integration

Board Advisor

Leader: Jude Bricker (ex-Sun Country CEO)

Role: Cultural bridge, integration advisor

McChrystal Relevance: Warm introduction to Sun Country culture

Chairman

Leader: Maury Gallagher

Role: Board governance, founder influence

McChrystal Relevance: Strategic alignment

Cargo Operations

Leader: [Sun Country Cargo VP]

Role: Amazon relationship preservation

McChrystal Relevance: Business continuity

Labor Relations

Leader: [VP Labor/HR]

Role: ALPA/IBT seniority negotiation

McChrystal Relevance: Union coordination

9f. Opportunity Thesis

Why Now: Antitrust clearance (March 2026) -> closing expected mid-2026. The 3-6 month window between now and closing is when integration planning happens. Day 1 readiness requires starting now. Every week of delay reduces integration planning quality.

Why McChrystal, Not McKinsey: Oliver Wyman provides aviation strategy. Seabury handles airline restructuring. But neither builds the operational coordination architecture for a safety-critical integration. McChrystal's military credibility - coordinating multi-unit operations where failure has life-or-death consequences - is uniquely differentiated in aviation.

Phased Engagement: Phase 1 (\$400K-\$500K): Integration coordination design - Day 1 readiness plan, cross-airline operating rhythm, union coordination framework. Phase 2 (\$700K-\$1M): Integration execution through closing and first 6 months post-close. Phase 3 (\$300K-\$500K retainer): Ongoing integration management through full operational integration (18-24 months). Total: \$1.5M-\$2.5M.

Multi-Threaded Pursuit:

- Thread 1: Robert Neal (President/CFO) - integration execution. Angle: "What's your Day 1 readiness plan and where are the coordination gaps?"
- Thread 2: SVP Operations - safety-critical integration. Angle: "How do you maintain safety standards while merging two complete airline operations?"
- Thread 3: Jude Bricker (board advisor) - cultural bridge. Angle: "As the person ensuring a smooth integration, what organizational support would accelerate the cultural alignment?" McChrystal's military background may resonate with aviation culture.
- Warm Introduction Vectors: Aviation industry connections; military/veteran network (airline industry employs many former military pilots); Las Vegas business community; airline industry conferences (IATA, Airlines for America).